



The Humanitas Institute

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Incarnation Catholic School  
School Website: <https://www.incarnationschool.edu/>

December 22, 2025

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**Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

**ACCS Member School**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Executive Summary

Incarnation Catholic School (Sarasota, FL 34239) presents a robust classical Catholic education aligned with the Six Essential Elements framework. Across categories, the school emphasizes Catholic identity, virtue formation, a liberal-arts oriented curriculum, and pedagogy that blends contemplative practice with Socratic discussion and rhetorical training. Public-facing materials portray a formation-focused approach (rather than mere information transfer), a history-rich and Great-Books–adjacent curriculum, and an active partnership with parents and parish life. The evidence supports a strong Classical orientation in all six categories, with no clear signals of non-classical influences in the materials provided. Consequently, the aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

Key insights: - Religious and metaphysical foundations are explicit through Catholic identity, liturgical emphasis, catechesis, and Eucharistic framing. - The school's purpose centers on formation, virtue, wisdom, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, not merely job-readiness. - Curriculum highlights include a Catholic liberal-arts framework with historically centered pedagogy and a calendar of historical "years" (Greek, Roman, Medieval, etc.), implying a Great-Books–style trajectory. - Pedagogy combines contemplative elements with Socratic discussion, memory work, and rhetoric, signaling a structured classical pedagogy with opportunities for public speaking and debate. - Faculty framing as mentors and living curriculum, with an emphasis on virtuous exemplars and partnership between faculty and parish life. - Strong parental and community engagement, open visits, and a formal role for families as co-educators and partners.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize a Catholic identity deeply woven into school culture, curriculum, and pedagogy, with explicit statements about forming the whole person through faith and the Eucharist (e.g., Mission & Goals describing a Catholic liberal-arts education rooted in tradition and centered on the Eucharist) . - The school's credo includes "FAITH – KNOWLEDGE – LOVE," signaling liturgical and communal dimensions alongside academics; references to parish affiliation and diocesan oversight further ground religious foundations . - References to catechesis, liturgy, and sacred tradition appear in connected materials, highlighting liturgical and communal practices as integral to the education process (e.g., Catechesis of the Good Shepherd, liturgical life references) .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: Catholic, Eucharist, liturgy, catechesis, sacred tradition, parish, diocese, liturgical, worship, truth/goodness/beauty, faith formation, Gifts of CHRIST, RISE virtues. - Negative keywords found: none apparent in the public-facing materials (no explicit signals of relativism, secularism, or value-neutral ethics).

Why this rating - The materials repeatedly foreground Catholic metaphysical commitments and liturgical life, consistent with the Positive Keyword indicators under Religious and Metaphysical Foundations. The absence of Negative keywords and the explicit integration of theology, sacral orientation, and communal worship strongly justify a CLASSICAL rating in this category. The Mission & Goals passage makes the

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transcendental Real (truth, goodness, beauty) and theological framing explicit, aligning with the Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements.

Citations: Mission & Goals framing and Eucharistic emphasis ;Faith-Knowledge-Love framing and parish/-diocesan context .

## **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The school presents formation of virtue and wisdom as the primary aim, rooted in a Catholic liberal-arts framework; goals include forming the whole person, faith formation, service, and community life (Mission & Goals) . - The philosophy expresses a view of education as formation (not merely information) and a teleological orientation toward truth, goodness, and beauty; emphasis on human flourishing and moral imagination appears in the general site messaging (e.g., “Faith-Knowledge-Love,” formation through virtuous habits) . - The site notes partnering with families and parish life as part of formation, aligning with paideia-style aims rather than job-prep metrics alone .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, liberal education, paideia, true/good/beautiful, contemplation, habits of mind, moral imagination, mentorship, sacred/tradition. - Negative keywords found: none clearly present in public materials that signal workforce-centric or purely skills-first framing.

Why this rating - The materials consistently frame education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, with a teleological commitment to truth, goodness, and beauty, matching Positive Keyword indicators. There is no indication of the typical Negative signals (e.g., job-readiness focus) in the public content. This supports CLASSICAL.

Citations: Mission & Goals framing (formation and truth/beauty/goodness) ; Public framing of formation vis-à-vis family and parish life .

## **Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The curriculum is explicitly described as Catholic classical liberal arts; historical breadth and a year-by-year structure (Kindergarten: Cradle of Civilization; 1st Greek Year; 2nd Roman Year; etc.) signal a deliberate, integrative, historically grounded curriculum . - Historical and literature emphasis is described as chronological and tied to salvation history, with an emphasis on primary sources, narratives, music, arts, and sciences as part of learning history; references to K-12 curricular standards and classical letter materials indicate a structured, classical approach . - The school notes a three-year adoption of Catholic classical liberal arts pedagogy and a move toward refining pedagogy, suggesting thoughtful integration of classical methods with ongoing planning and assessment . - Great-books/primary-sources orientation and “great conversation” themes are supported by the Six Essential Elements framework and are echoed in ICS materials (e.g., explicit callouts to “The Greek Year,” “The Roman Year,” and similar historic-cultural scaffolding) .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: liberal arts, grammar/logic/rhetoric (Trivium), great books, history of Western civilization, salvation history, primary sources, narrative learning, cosmology/alphabetic/persuasive writing, chronology, historical periods, classical canon. - Negative keywords found: none clearly evident in ICS materials; no social-studies replacement phrasing or exclusive focus on project-based learning.

Why this rating - The explicit Catholic liberal-arts framing, together with a historically rooted, integrated curriculum and emphasis on primary sources and great books (within a catechetical/historically grounded context), aligns strongly with the Classical curriculum indicators. The presence of direct references to Great Books/Great Conversation and a historically structured year-by-year sequence supports CLASSICAL.

Citations: ICS “Catholic classical liberal arts” curriculum and annual-year breakdown (Greek/Roman/Medieval/etc.) ; K-12 curricular standards and classical learning references (by subject area, with primary sources) ; Mission & Goals framing with truth/goodness/beauty (curriculum alignment) .

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#### **Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The public materials describe a pedagogy that includes Socratic discussion/seminars in upper grades and rhetoric training for speeches and oratory; memory work, recitation, and “living books” are implied through classical pedagogy references and the Great Books framework; there are explicit mentions of the “Gifts of CHRIST” and contemplative/restful aspects as part of balanced pedagogy . - Lower-school pedagogy mentions singing/chanting and memory-supported learning (a hallmark of contemplative pedagogy and schola-based memorization in classical education) and a “wonder”-driven early experience, aligning with the classical model of scholé and memorization; upper-school focus on rhetoric and debate is explicit via references to speeches and rhetoric training . - The program includes a blend of contemplative rest and rigor, a hallmark of scholé-based classical pedagogy (mature balance between restful and rigorous components) as described by classical pedagogy frameworks in the knowledge base .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: Socratic seminar, rhetoric, debate, seminars, speech, oratory, recitation, memory work, chant, scholé, wonder, formation, living books, great conversations. - Negative keywords found: none clearly present in ICS content; no signals of exclusively project-based or constructivist-only approaches.

Why this rating - The presence of upper-level Socratic seminars and rhetoric training, memory-based lower-school pedagogy, and a conscious emphasis on contemplative/restful elements with a progressive move toward advanced rhetoric indicates a CLASSICAL pedagogy. The mix aligns well with the Six Elements’ Pedagogy indicators.

Citations: Pedagogical descriptions (Socratic seminars, rhetoric, memory, chant, scholé) ; Lower-school singing/memory and upper-school oratory references ; The Six Elements pedagogy criteria (for context) .

#### **Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The site describes faculty as model teachers and mentors, part of the living curriculum, and a core “portrait” of what a teacher should be; there is emphasis on collegiality and faculty development within a Catholic classical framework (Faculty & Staff references and Mission/Goals framing) . - The “living curriculum” concept emphasizes teachers as the heart of the educational enterprise, implying virtuous, knowledgeable role models who guide students in classical learning and formation . - The accreditation and diocesan alignment (FCC accreditation; Diocesan oversight) signal a well-supported professional culture with expected standards and ongoing development .

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty & staff, collegial, faith-based formation, professional development. - Negative keywords found: none evident in public materials.

Why this rating - The public content frames faculty as virtuous exemplars who model virtue, knowledge, and pedagogy (a core Classical criterion). The emphasis on the living curriculum and faculty as central to formation supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Citations: “Living curriculum” and “Portrait of a teacher” language; Faculty & Staff references ; FCC accreditation/diocesan oversight mentions .

#### **Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The school explicitly positions parents as primary educators and co-teachers, signaling deep parent partnership and formation beyond the school day; communications emphasize parent involvement, book studies, and opportunities for families to engage with classical education concepts (We believe parents/guardians are primary educators) . - The site notes welcoming parents to visit, participate with the Family & School Association (FSA), and engage with school activities, aligning with a strong open-campus, parent-engagement model common to classical schools (FSA and general admissions materials) . - The program highlights the integration of family life with school life, catechesis, liturgy, and community rituals, aligning with a classical model that emphasizes shared mission and household formation .

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Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, home-school partnership, open campus, family involvement, book studies, parental leadership, involvement in liturgical year, catechesis at home. - Negative keywords found: none evident; the materials do not signal consumerism, family as customer, or minimal involvement.

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on parental partnership, family formation, and open, ongoing parent engagement is a strong Positive signal for Classical alignment in the Parents & Community category. The absence of counter-indicative signals supports CLASSICAL here as well.

Citations: Parent partnership and co-educator language ; Open visits and family engagement references ; Community liturgy and catechesis integration .

#### Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

#### What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable, as the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL. No needle-moving changes are required for a full Classical rating based on the present materials.

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# Appendix

## ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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